# Porirua U3A Interest Groups for 2026

https://www.poriruau3a.nz

"Wisdom is not a product of schooling, but of the lifelong attempt to acquire it" - Albert Einstein

## Astronomy/Cosmology

When: Monthly, Commencing Tuesday 17th February 2026
Time: 2-3 pm
Venue: Tawa Union Church, 6 Elena Place, Tawa

This is a small group of members who are keen to learn and share their knowledge about our night sky, solar system, cosmos, and much more.
Everyone is welcome, and you do not need a science background to enjoy this group. New members are welcome!
There is a small fee of approximately $4 for each meeting to cover room hire.

Co-ordinator: Michael Lynch
Telephone: 022 606 8066 Email: m.lynch@xtra.co.nz

## Book Discussion 1

When: 2nd Tuesday. Beginning February 2026
Time: 10 am
Venue: Each meeting is held at the home of a member who acts as host and leads the discussion, or at Whitby Lakes Retirement Village every second Tuesday.

In addition to studying two or three selected titles in detail, we try to cover a wide range of topics and authors in different genres during the year. If interested, please give Lesley a call.

Co-ordinator: Lesley Harrison
Mobile: 021 161 5475 Email: lesleymargaret@hotmail.co.nz

## Book Discussion 2

When: Second Thursday of April - November 2026
Time: 1:30 pm
Venue: Each meeting is held at the home of a member.

Members read and talk about the book they have read according to the month's genre.
This introduces members to a wide variety of titles and authors. If this sounds like you, please join us.

Co-ordinator: Carolyn Rait
Telephone: 021 121 0218 Email: carolyn.rait@gmail.com

## Bridge

When: Weekly Mondays commencing 12th January 2026
Time: 9:30 am
Venue: Plimmerton Croquet Club rooms, Ulric Street, Plimmerton Industrial Estate.

The group plays social bridge, and no bridge experience is necessary. Prospective players can just turn up or contact Ian.

Co-ordinator: Ian Fowler
Telephone: (04) 233 0045 Email: idnfowler@hotmail.com Cellphone: 027 343 2443

## Creative writing

When: Every 3rd Wednesday
Time: 10 am
Venue: We take turns to meet in each other's houses.

This group aims to write for enjoyment and the sharing of stories with others.
A focus for our writing is decided at each meeting and can include 'Anniversary', 'A Trump story', 'Maps', or an 'ABC' mystery. Sometimes we explore the intricacies of writing poetry. At other times, we write about our own experiences or explore writing fiction. We share our stories at the meeting. At times, members of the group share past stories. We enjoy our time together over a cup of tea or coffee and something to eat.

As we meet at each other's houses, this group is limited to 10 people. If needed, an overflow creative writing group will be formed, meeting on the first Wednesday of each month for an additional 10 people.

Co-ordinator: Joan Reader
Telephone: 04 233 8041 Email: jreader@actrix.co.nz

## Film Group at the Lighthouse

When: 3rd Saturday of the month, commencing 17 January 2026
Time: Varies according to session times.
Venue: The Lighthouse, Pauatahanui.

Members are advised of the decision on timing, on Tuesday or Wednesday prior. We have coffee afterwards to look at a few reviews and discuss the film.

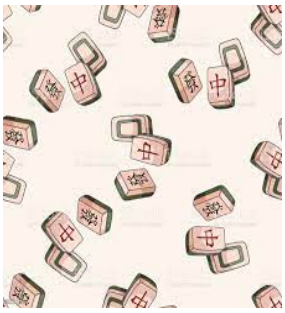
Co-ordinator: Jan Grainger
Telephone/Mobile: 021 176 2304 Email: janhgrainger@gmail.com

## Garden

When: Currently in recess.
Time: TBA
Venue: TBA

Our Garden Group is currently in recess, and we are hoping that a previous member — or someone new with a love of gardening —may be willing to take it over. The group has traditionally been a friendly mix of experienced gardeners and newcomers, sharing ideas, practical advice, and gardening-related activities in a relaxed and sociable setting. Meetings usually included light morning tea, with occasional visits to local gardens and homes. If you enjoy gardening and would be interested in helping to coordinate or host this group, we would love to hear from you. The group would continue in much the same way, with a friendly and supportive atmosphere.

Contact: Bill Gebbie. Mob. 027 6770 180 Email: billnmary@xtra.co.nz



## Mahjong

When: Wednesdays, weekly commencing 14th January 2026
Time: 1:30-3:30 pm
Venue: Plimmerton Croquet rooms, Ulric Street.

There is a small fee of $4 per session to cover the room hire. This is a social group suitable for both experienced and new players. Lessons will be held throughout the year.

Co-ordinator: Marcia Forsman
Telephone: 021 406 570 Email: marcia@venture.co.nz

## Play Reading

When: Second Friday, May-September 2026
Time: 10 am
Venue: TBC

Our tutor, Pat Knight, has sourced a varied range of reading material for us, covering comedy, short skits, Oscar Wild etc. A small charge is made towards photocopying as required. This ensures a copy of the current reading for each person's use. We begin with coffee or tea. This group is not at all serious, and we have a lot of fun. Acting experience is not necessary.

Co-ordinator: Pat Knight
Telephone: (04) 233 6634 Email: patknight@xtra.co.nz

## Science

When: Mondays, fortnightly commencing 16th February 2026
Time: 10 am to noon
Venue: Combined Church, Mana Ave, Titahi Bay.

Curious about the world around you? Our Science Group explores a wide range of fascinating topics — from environmental issues and renewable energy to supervolcanoes, animals surviving in a human world, strange mathematics, the Large Hadron Collider, artificial intelligence, robots, dragonflies, and even the science of music. We begin with a friendly cuppa and a chance to socialise before enjoying short documentaries, conversation, and lively discussion. No science background is needed — just curiosity and an open mind. There is a small hall hire and morning tea/coffee fee of $5-7, which we hope to reduce as membership grows. New members are always welcome.

Co-ordinator: Michael Lynch
Mobile. 022 606 8066 Email: m.lynch@xtra.co.nz

## Scrabble

When: Commencing 16th January 2026, and every second Friday thereafter.
Time: 10 am
Venue: Tawa Community Centre, 5 Cambridge Street, Tawa

After a cuppa (including an assortment of delicious cakes or biscuits) and a catch-up, we form two teams and play one (or sometimes two) games. It doesn't matter whether you've played Scrabble a lot or only occasionally; we always have fun and come away having spent a great morning together. Contact Bill if you're interested in joining our group.

Co-ordinator: Bill Gebbie
Telephone: 027 6770 180 Email: billnmary@xtra.co.nz

## Tai-Chi

When: Weekly on Fridays commencing 13th February 2026
Time: 10 am - 11 am
Venue: Tawa Union Church, Elena Place, Tawa. (Held in conjunction with Tawa U3A)

These classes are led by Mercedes, an experienced Tai Chi instructor, and cater to seniors across both Tawa and Porirua U3As. These classes are proving to be extremely popular.
Tai Chi helps to improve balance, flexibility, and overall mental and physical health. This results in better sleep quality, improved blood circulation and cognitive functions, and reduced stress and anxiety.
A donation of $2 per session covers the hall's hire fee, and there is a donation/koha for our instructor, Mercedes, who has to travel from the Hutt Valley and volunteers her time.
New members are welcome.

Co-ordinator: Michael Lynch (In conjunction with Tawa U3A Co-ordinator)
Telephone: 022 606 8066 Email: m.lynch@xtra.co.nz

## These Changing Times

When: Thursdays, fortnightly. Beginning February - November 2026
Time: 10 am
Venue: Meeting at a member's home or TBA

We discuss a range of topical issues from history to science to education, both locally and abroad. We also discuss topical issues, nominated before each meeting by a group member. Issues are agreed on before the next meeting with a person or persons selected to lead the discussion. Research material may be required or sent out depending on the topic. Discussions are both interesting and lively.

Co-ordinator: Michael Lynch

Telephone: 022 606 8066 Email: m.lynch@xtra.co.nz

## Possible Groups

If there is enough interest, we will begin other groups, eg. An Opera Group or a Walking Group.

Contact: Bill Gebbie
Telephone: 027 6770 180
Email: billnmary@xtra.co.nz